

PISTACHIO CHICKEN BREASTS WITH HERB-GARLIC CHEESE FILLING *Serves 8*

HERB-GARLIC CHEESE FILLING

8 ounces cream cheese, softened
1 teaspoon minced garlic
1 tablespoon minced parsley
½ teaspoon pepper
1–2 tablespoons minced fresh basil or ½ teaspoon dried
¼ teaspoon salt

CHICKEN

8 boneless, skinless chicken breast halves
½ cup flour combined with 1 teaspoon each salt and pepper
2 eggs, beaten
1½ cups finely ground pistachio nuts (about 7 ounces shelled)
¼ cup clarified butter (see p. 124 for how to make)

FILLING

Combine the cream cheese with the garlic, herbs, and seasonings. Chill until firm and then form into eight 2"-long cylinders. Keep refrigerated until ready to use.

CHICKEN

Preheat the oven to 350°. Gently pound chicken breasts between wax paper until each is ¼" thick. For each portion, put 1 portion of the filling along 1 edge of a pounded chicken breast and fold and roll the chicken over the filling to completely and securely enclose it. Repeat with each piece of chicken. Roll each piece sequentially in the seasoned flour, the beaten eggs, and finally the ground pistachios and sauté in the clarified butter over medium heat for 1–2 minutes on each side or until lightly browned. Transfer the chicken to a baking pan and put in the preheated oven for 15–20 minutes. Serve hot.

FROM BETH'S KITCHEN